

Monday, August 22

Adolph was at the door at 7:15. He had driven in from the lake. None of us were up when he arrived, but breakfast was on the table by 7:50. After the meal was eaten and the equipment prepared Adolph and I drove ahead, Peter and Papa came behind. Within 1 1/2 hours the storage shed was loaded. We were invited in for coffee although Cheryl's grandparents were unable to sit with us. Mrs. Isaachsen was off to the Canwood doctor to have a painfully swollen hand checked.

Coffee was finished and Mr. Isaachsen was getting into his car. My car was parked some distance behind his. Papa seemed to know something I didn't. He moved towards my car, and called to me: "David, hurry up. He's backing his car. He might hit you."

Peter was drawn to Papa by the urgency of his voice. In the moments that I needed to get my keys in the ignition and the car started and in gear, Grandpa was upon me. I feared I couldn't clear out in time. I braced for a collision.

Instead, I heard Papa: "Hurry Dave, he's going to hit you, yes . . . no . . . Whoa."

He stepped between the two cars. Grandpa's head was turned, but not enough to see me. He was smiling.

"Whoa," Papa called again, "He's not the world's greatest driver."

"What?" Peter yelled, "Grandpa's not the world's greatest driver. Is that what you said?"

"Yes... No. I said he is the world's greatest driver."

Peter was gone. He was running after Grandpa.

"Peter." Papa called. "Come here and be with me. Let's see what Adolph is doing. Shucks, he was going to tell him what I said. That's all I need."

The shed was brought to Henry's, unloaded and put into place with blocks. After dinner the granary floor was repaired, a clearing was made in the bush to put the metal shed, and these two buildings were blocked up. Peter was involved, moving things out of the shed at Isaachsen's, riding the tractor, watching at every angle. He rode with Adolph on the way back. We kidded Adolph about the long ride. He laughed too and said something about Peter's endless question, particularly about his hunting.

Cheryl was busy with Matthew. She found him tiring of the house so they went outside to the machinery. After the ride on the garden tractor he was never again content to be inside. Peter had him on the tractor and allowed him to steer. Then Peter, Matthew and I went out to the field to watch Leroy Larsen swathe. Peter sat between my legs and steered. Matthew stood on my legs and held Peter's shoulder. Whenever he sees machinery he pumps his body and claps his hands. Peter was on the grey tractor alone when I was cleaning up lumber. When I was walking up from the barn, Peter on the tractor was slightly ahead. He said, "Let's race." I walked faster. He lost his smile, put up his hand and said, "Don't run." I continued closing the gap. He was so concerned he forgot about his driving and hit a tree.

Adolph left after supper. Cheryl's parents went to Isaachsen's to clean where the building were. Peter and I went for a motorcycle ride. He was very tired. After putting the bike away we walked to the house.

He said, "I wonder what the doctor did to Grandma's hand."

I said, "I don't know."

"Maybe he had to cut it open. And write little words on it. And everybody would come and see the words and say "Googa. Googa-googa."

His hands held this idea like a ball.

Both boys were washed and put to bed. Leroy dropped in until Betty picked him up. The moon is full and over bright.